Step 2: Food list

Food list is the list of quantities of various food groups to be included in the diet so that it is balanced and can meet the RDA. This can be done by:

- Selecting food from all the four food groups.
- Deciding the quantities of the selected as multiples of portion sizes.

Food list can be prepared either by using ICMR tables or exchange lists.

i. Using ICMR tables

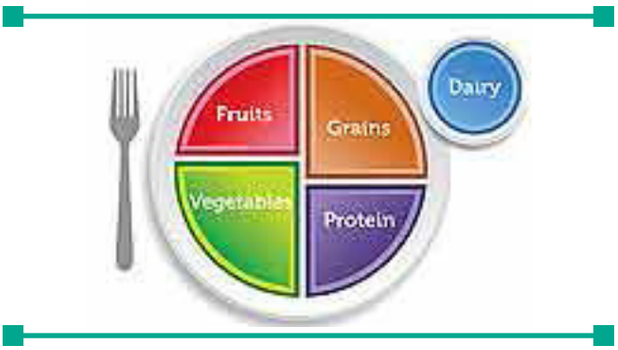
To make menu planning more convenient ICMR has suggested the portion size and balanced diets for adults and for different age groups. The portion sizes are given in terms of raw food.

ii. The Exchange Lists

The Exchange Lists are the basis of a meal planning. Food exchange lists are groups of measured foods of the same calorific value and similar protein, fat and carbohydrate content. All foods of exchange lists make a specific contribution to a good diet. Food exchange lists help in manipulation of protein, calories and other nutrients.

Step 3: Meal plan

The foods that are listed are converted into recipes and distributed in various meals like breakfast, lunch and dinner. My Plate helps individuals to make better food choices and eat healthfully. It illustrates the food groups using a familiar mealtime visual.



▲ Fig 1 My Plate

Table 3 Portion Size And Nutrient Content

Food Groups	Portion G	Energy Kcal	Protein g	Carbohydrate g	Fat g
Cereals and millets	30	100	3.0	20	0.8
Pulses	30	100	6.0	**15**	0.7
Egg	50	85	7.0	-	**7.0**
Meat/chicken or fish	100	100	9	-	**7.0**
Milk(ml) and milk product	100	70	3.0	**5**	**3.0**
Roots and tubers	100	80	1.3	**19**	-
Green leafy vegetables	100	45	3.6	-	**0.4**
Other vegetables	100	30	1.7	-	**0.2**
Fruits	100	40	-	**10**	-
Sugars	5	20	-	**5**	-
Fats and oils	5	45	-	-	**5**

Source: Dietary guidelines for Indians, National Institute of Nutrition, Hyderabad, (2011).

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